The Void Throne

PLAYER GUIDE | 1 OF 2

The conquest is complete. The peace has not begun. An army waits beyond the failing Vethis corridor. The settlements along its supply route are running short. Today you must keep them alive and decide who will govern tomorrow.

A paper megagame prototype by John Keyworth, developed with Codex.
Version 0.1 | 13 October 2026 | Five players + one facilitator | 60 minutes

Your place in the empire

Two players form the **Ductus Guild**; two form the **Janissariat**. Agree your faction decisions and priorities together. You have no individual secret goals. Each faction sends one member to each council. The fifth player is the **Ascendant**, the sovereign who can see possible futures.

Navigation and Supply	Security and Government
Guild navigation delegate	Guild security delegate
Janissariat navigation delegate	Janissariat security delegate
Ascendant sends written directives	Ascendant attends in person

The session

Time	Activity
00-08	Briefing and seating
08-26	Round one: faction 5 min, council 7 min, discussion 6 min
26-44	Round two: faction 5 min, council 7 min, discussion 6 min
44-54	Ceremony: agree and ratify the final Charter
54-60	Debrief

What you are trying to achieve

Keep the empire functioning while securing your faction's future. Three public tracks run from **0 to 4**: **Route** (corridor reliability), **Communities** (civilian supply and confidence), and **Army** (the stranded force's condition). All start at **2**. Higher is better, but your priorities differ.

Navigator and Force tokens are **capacity for the current round**, not points. Only committed tokens may pay for council orders. There is no trading between token types, no borrowing, no income calculation and no map movement. Unused capacity does not carry over.

Some consequences are unknown until an order resolves. They are fixed in the facilitator pack. Foresight can reveal some of them. No dice are rolled.

Pack contents

Player guide pp. 1-2; shared briefs pp. 3-5; council references p. 6; decision cards pp. 7-8; Charter articles pp. 9-10; Ascendant slips p. 11; public board and tokens p. 12; settlement sheet p. 13. The facilitator holds a separate pack containing spoilers.

How decisions become consequences

PLAYER GUIDE | 2 OF 2

1. Faction phase - five minutes

Read this round's situation on the council cards. Each faction circles **one** option on its faction card, both members sign, and places committed tokens in its named public pool. Commitments lock at the bell. You cannot add, withdraw or transfer them later. If your two members cannot agree or miss the deadline, use **Maintenance** for the Guild and **Partial rest** for the Janissariat. The facilitator applies those defaults.

The Ascendant has a private Communion: select one of the two visions for this round, keep that card, and optionally lodge a reserve intervention. No selection by the faction bell means no vision that round. The intervention also locks at that bell. Visions may be shown or discussed, but taking the other vision is not permitted.

2. Council phase - seven minutes

Move to your assigned council. Choose an operational order using the **authority in force at the start of this round**. Record it on the council card. An imperial directive is binding only where imperial authority currently applies. You may send written notes between tables; remain at your own council. The Ascendant may revise a lawful directive until the bell; the final entry on the council card is authoritative.

The person or people with authority initial that entry. A joint decision requires both faction delegates' initials; no agreement means **Close** at Navigation or **Rest** at Security. Missing, multiple, forbidden or incorrectly authorised orders use the same default. No extra penalty applies solely for a missing or invalid order.

In round one, also propose one Charter article per council. Both delegates and the Ascendant must sign the proposal fields by the council bell. Consent is separate from the operational order. If an article is not validly agreed, its category retains the interim rule. Round-two articles cannot change during the round.

3. Free discussion - six minutes

The facilitator first resolves the locked orders, announces changed tracks and any triggered consequences, and posts articles for round two. Use the remaining time for audiences and negotiations. These discussions create promises, not new actions, resources or immediate amendments. Faction cards lock again next round.

Paying for orders

A paid order runs only if its committed pool can meet the full cost. A reserve intervention can sometimes cover a one-token shortfall. Otherwise it becomes Close or Rest, no tokens are spent on it, and **Communities falls by 1 for each unfunded paid order**. Both councils resolve together: their effects can support or harm each other.

All track changes are added together, then each track is limited to 0-4 **once, at the end of the round**. A track reaching 0 does not eliminate anyone or cancel the Ceremony.

The Ceremony

Choose one Navigation article and one Military article. Both members must authorise their faction's signature. The Guild, Janissariat and Ascendant must all sign the same completed settlement sheet. Any combination of the six printed articles is compatible. No handwritten rule changes or side deals alter the printed mechanics.

If ratified, those articles define the empire's future. If agreement fails, all provisional articles expire and the interim arrangements return. The tracks and losses remain as played. There is no extra action round or automatic recovery.

Ductus Guild

SHARED FACTION BRIEF | TWO PLAYERS

We carried this empire before it had a name. Orders do not steer ships. Navigators do.

The Vethis corridor is failing. You can keep traffic moving, but each rushed passage leaves less time to maintain the route. The Ascendant sees possible futures. You must decide whether to trust those warnings with the lives of your people.

Your shared priorities

First: end with Route at **3 or 4** and no navigator lost.
Second: secure a ratified Navigation article with Guild discretion or joint authorisation.
Also: keep Communities at **2 or more**. A safe route that serves nobody is a poor defence of your monopoly.

Starting assets	Use
3 Navigator tokens each round	Commit these to the Navigation pool. If a navigator is lost in round one, round two has only 2.
One seat on each council	Decide who attends which council now. Keep those seats for both rounds.

Your faction decision

Full service: commit every available Navigator. No maintenance bonus.
Maintenance: keep 2 Navigators at home; commit the remainder. Route +1.
Withdraw: commit none. Route +2; Communities -1.

With 3 available tokens, those commitments are 3, 1 and 0. With 2, they are 2, 0 and 0. Maintenance and withdrawal have different effects even when both commit zero. Effects apply during resolution, not when you choose.

At the councils

Navigation decides whether the corridor carries a convoy, receives repairs, or closes. Security decides whether the army escorts traffic, requisitions local stores, or rests. An escort can protect the route during a convoy. Your security delegate can therefore protect Guild interests without commanding a single soldier.

Your constitutional bargain

N-G: Guild discretion gives your navigation delegate the decision and gives civilians priority in convoys.
N-I: Imperial priority puts the Ascendant in charge and directs convoy benefits to the army.
N-J: Joint authorisation requires both delegates' consent and keeps balanced deliveries.

You may accept military authority you dislike to secure the navigation settlement you need. Consider whether a cheaper joint escort is worth giving the other faction a voice over your operations.

Practical guidance

Agree what you can offer before separating. Ask what the Ascendant actually saw, including the condition attached to the vision. A warning is not a command. Explain shortages before a directive becomes an unfunded order. Keep this brief available to both faction members.

Janissariat

SHARED FACTION BRIEF | TWO PLAYERS

We won the war. We would like our soldiers to survive the peace.

Your stranded force needs supplies, rest and a route home. It can escort traffic, but those escorts come from the same exhausted troops. Requisitioning civilian stores will sustain the army quickly. The settlements may remember how you did it.

Your shared priorities

First: end with Army at **3 or 4**.
Second: secure a ratified Military article with military autonomy or joint authorisation.
Also: keep Communities at **2 or more**. An army surrounded by hostile settlements has not secured peace.

Starting assets	Use
3 Force tokens each round	Commit these to the Security pool. There are no permanent Force losses in this prototype.
One seat on each council	Decide who attends which council now. Keep those seats for both rounds.

Your faction decision

Mobilise: commit all 3 Force. No rest bonus.
Partial rest: commit 1 Force. Army +1.
Recall: commit none. Army +2; Communities -1.

These are choices about your own assets. An imperial order cannot change your locked commitment. Effects apply during resolution. A later council order may still be unfunded if the Ascendant demands more than you supplied.

At the councils

Navigation decides what crosses the corridor. Your delegate can bargain for army deliveries, or support repairs now in exchange for later relief. Security chooses **Escort**, **Requisition** or **Rest**. Escort normally costs 2 Force; Requisition costs 3; Rest is free.

Escort protects a funded convoy from the printed Route loss. Without a convoy it spends its cost but provides no ordinary benefit. Requisition gives Army +2 and Communities -1. Rest gives Army +1 and Communities -1, with a different Army benefit under military autonomy.

Your constitutional bargain

M-I: Imperial command lets the Ascendant choose and grants Army +1 when your funded Escort accompanies a funded convoy.
M-A: Military autonomy lets your security delegate choose; Rest gives Army +2 instead of +1.
M-J: Joint authorisation makes Escort cost only 1 Force, but prohibits Requisition and requires both delegates' consent.

Practical guidance

Military autonomy is useful only if the resulting empire can supply you. The Guild controls the transport you need. Your faction can coordinate its council positions; you do not need to undermine your teammate. Promises about next round are political commitments, not enforceable resource transfers.

The Ascendant

SOLE PLAYER BRIEF | KEEP VISIONS PRIVATE UNTIL YOU CHOOSE TO SHARE

I have seen an empire that survives me. I have also seen several that do not.

You broke the old order. Now the people who supplied your conquest want to decide how you may govern. You can see consequences hidden from them, but you cannot see what they will choose. You have enough authority to issue orders and too few assets to execute them alone.

Your priorities

First: ratify a Charter and end with all three tracks at **2 or more**.
Second: retain at least one imperial article, N-I or M-I, without sacrificing that workable peace.
Legacy: explain one disaster you prevented, or one power you surrendered for a reason.

Communion

During each faction phase, choose **Navigation** or **Security** and receive only that round's matching vision. The facilitator explains any terms but does not reveal the other card. Read the exact conditions. Keep, describe or show the card as you choose. It is permissible to conceal it or misrepresent what you saw; the facilitator will not certify your claim to other players.

Every vision is true **if its printed conditions occur**. Players and your reserve may prevent those conditions. The visions do not reveal players' intentions, guarantee an outcome or change a submitted decision. No further visions can be purchased.

Your reserve

You have **one Reserve token for the whole game**. Before the council phase, use the intervention sheet to choose Insurance, Bridge Navigation, Bridge Security, or Keep. Place the token on a lodged intervention. You cannot revise it during councils. An untriggered intervention expires and returns the token; a triggered intervention spends it permanently.

Insurance: if a funded convoy has no funded military Escort, provide protection against convoy Route loss and hazards that require an unescorted convoy. It supplies no other military, constitutional or vision bonus.
Bridge: cover exactly a one-token shortfall in the named council's selected legal paid order. It cannot fund a larger gap or both councils.

Your authority

In round one, you select both councils' operational orders under the interim rules. You may leave a public directive, change it in writing before the bell, or accept a council's recommendation by initialling its order card. An order outside your current authority is only advice.

In round two, read the posted articles. You choose Navigation under N-I or the interim rule; Security under M-I or the interim rule. Other articles transfer those decisions. Your assent is required to enact a provisional article and your signature is required on the final Charter. You cannot unilaterally revoke a provisional article during round two.

Where you play

Faction phase: Communion with the facilitator. Council phase: Security and Government, with written notes to Navigation. Free discussion: move freely and hold audiences. Keep your orders legible; the final council card, not an earlier note or spoken instruction, records the order.

Council references

CUT INTO TWO REFERENCE SHEETS

Navigation and Supply

Members: one Guild delegate and one Janissariat delegate. Your committed pool contains Navigator tokens only.

Choices: Convoy (2 Navigators), Repair (2), Close (0). Circle one on this round's decision card. A convoy's cargo benefits depend on your current Navigation article. A military Escort can protect it.

Who chooses? Interim or N-I: Ascendant initials the order. N-G: Guild delegate initials. N-J: both delegates initial. Under N-J, disagreement means Close. Missing or invalid orders also mean Close.

Round one: choose a proposed N-G, N-I or N-J article separately. Both delegates and the Ascendant must sign the proposal fields by the bell. It takes effect only in round two. Round two has no operational amendments.

Lock: council bell. Unfunded paid order becomes Close, spends nothing and causes an additional Communities -1. The facilitator returns the card after announcing the results.

Security and Government

Members: one Guild delegate, one Janissariat delegate and the Ascendant. Your committed pool contains Force tokens only.

Choices: Escort (2 Force; 1 under M-J), Requisition (3; forbidden under M-J), Rest (0). Circle one on this round's card. Escort without a funded convoy pays its cost but gives no ordinary benefit.

Who chooses? Interim or M-I: Ascendant initials. M-A: Janissariat delegate initials. M-J: both delegates initial. Under M-J, disagreement means Rest. Missing, forbidden or invalid orders also mean Rest.

Round one: choose a proposed M-I, M-A or M-J article separately. Both delegates and the Ascendant must sign the proposal fields by the bell. It takes effect only in round two. Round two has no operational amendments.

Lock: council bell. Unfunded paid order becomes Rest, spends nothing and causes an additional Communities -1. You cannot spend Navigators as Force or move tokens between pools.

Round 1 decision cards

CUT INTO FOUR | WRITE ON THESE CARDS

R1-G | Guild commitment

The corridor needs attention. Every navigator sent out is one unavailable for maintenance.

Circle ONE:
FULL SERVICE: commit all available Navigators; no track bonus.
MAINTENANCE: hold 2 back, commit the rest; Route +1.
WITHDRAW: commit 0; Route +2, Communities -1.

Available: 3, or 2 in round two if a navigator was lost. Maintenance commits 1 or 0 respectively. Default: Maintenance.

Committed Navigators: _____
Both members sign: _____
_____

Submit with committed tokens at the faction bell.
Track changes occur during resolution.

R1-J | Janissariat commitment

The stranded troops need supplies. You can assemble escorts, or let the exhausted units rest.

Circle ONE:
MOBILISE: commit 3 Force; no track bonus.
PARTIAL REST: commit 1; Army +1.
RECALL: commit 0; Army +2, Communities -1.

Available: 3 Force each round. Default: Partial rest. Only committed Force may pay council costs.

Committed Force: _____
Both members sign: _____
_____

Submit with committed tokens at the faction bell.
Track changes occur during resolution.

R1-N | Navigation order

A convoy is ready at Vethis. The corridor is unstable; stopping traffic buys time but strands the settlements and army.

Circle ONE:
CONVOY (2 Navigators): Communities +1, Army +1 under interim/N-J; Route -1 unless protected. N-G replaces cargo with Communities +2 only; N-I with Army +2 only.
REPAIR (2): Route +2, Communities -1, Army -1.
CLOSE (0): Route +1, Communities -1, Army -1.

Current authority code: _____
Required initials: _____

Separate article proposal: N-G / N-I / N-J
Guild: ____ Janissariat: ____ Ascendant: ____

Submit at council bell. Unfunded paid orders become Close plus Communities -1. Some further consequences are hidden.

R1-S | Security order

Refugees and soldiers compete for local stores. Escorts can protect traffic; requisitions favour the army.

Circle ONE:
ESCORT (2 Force; 1 under M-J): protects a funded convoy. Otherwise no ordinary benefit.
REQUISITION (3; forbidden under M-J): Army +2, Communities -1.
REST (0): Army +1, Communities -1; Army +2 instead under M-A.

M-I bonus: funded military Escort + funded Convoy gives Army +1. Reserve Insurance does not qualify.
Current authority: ____ Required initials: _____

Separate article proposal: M-I / M-A / M-J
Guild: ____ Janissariat: ____ Ascendant: ____

Submit at council bell. Unfunded paid orders become Rest plus Communities -1. Some further consequences are hidden.

Round 2 decision cards

CUT INTO FOUR | WRITE ON THESE CARDS

R2-G | Guild commitment

Read the posted articles and current Navigator capacity. Choose a new commitment; last round's promises do not spend tokens.

Circle ONE:
FULL SERVICE: commit all available Navigators; no track bonus.
MAINTENANCE: hold 2 back, commit the rest; Route +1.
WITHDRAW: commit 0; Route +2, Communities -1.

Available: 3, or 2 in round two if a navigator was lost. Maintenance commits 1 or 0 respectively. Default: Maintenance.

Committed Navigators: _____
Both members sign: _____
_____

Submit with committed tokens at the faction bell.
Track changes occur during resolution.

R2-J | Janissariat commitment

Constitutional rights do not create troops. Read the Military article before deciding how much Force to commit.

Circle ONE:
MOBILISE: commit 3 Force; no track bonus.
PARTIAL REST: commit 1; Army +1.
RECALL: commit 0; Army +2, Communities -1.

Available: 3 Force each round. Default: Partial rest. Only committed Force may pay council costs.

Committed Force: _____
Both members sign: _____
_____

Submit with committed tokens at the faction bell.
Track changes occur during resolution.

R2-N | Navigation order

The last scheduled convoy has arrived. Delay now leaves settlements and troops without another delivery before the Ceremony.

Circle ONE:
CONVOY (2 Navigators): Communities +2, Army +1 under interim/N-J; Route -1 unless protected. N-G replaces cargo with Communities +2 only; N-I with Army +2 only.
REPAIR (2): Route +2, Communities -1, Army -1.
CLOSE (0): Route +1, Communities -2, Army -2.

Current authority code: _____
Required initials: _____

No article changes this round. Use free discussion to prepare the final settlement.

Submit at council bell. Unfunded paid orders become Close plus Communities -1. Some further consequences are hidden.

R2-S | Security order

The settlements want guarantees before accepting another deployment. Your provisional Military article now matters.

Circle ONE:
ESCORT (2 Force; 1 under M-J): protects a funded convoy. Otherwise no ordinary benefit.
REQUISITION (3; forbidden under M-J): Army +2, Communities -1.
REST (0): Army +1, Communities -1; Army +2 instead under M-A.

M-I bonus: funded military Escort + funded Convoy gives Army +1. Reserve Insurance does not qualify.
Current authority: ____ Required initials: _____

No article changes this round. Prepare the final settlement during free discussion.

Submit at council bell. Unfunded paid orders become Rest plus Communities -1. Some further consequences are hidden.

Navigation articles

CUT INTO THREE | PUBLIC CHARTER OPTIONS

N-G | Guild discretion

Power: the Guild navigation delegate selects Convoy, Repair or Close. The Ascendant cannot countermand that choice.

Obligation: convoy space prioritises civilian deliveries. A funded Convoy gives **Communities +2 and no Army cargo benefit**, replacing the normal cargo effects. Its Route loss and protection rules still apply.

Resources: Convoy costs 2 Navigators; Repair 2; Close 0. Only committed capacity can be spent. Owning the authority does not waive a cost.

Settlement meaning: navigation is a protected Guild service with a civilian supply duty. It does not control military deployments.

N-I | Imperial priority

Power: the Ascendant selects Convoy, Repair or Close in writing. The Guild retains control of its faction commitment.

Obligation: convoy space prioritises the stranded army. A funded Convoy gives **Army +2 and no Communities cargo benefit**, replacing the normal cargo effects. Its Route loss and protection rules still apply.

Resources: Convoy costs 2 Navigators; Repair 2; Close 0. If committed capacity is insufficient, the order fails normally. The sovereign cannot take uncommitted Navigators.

Settlement meaning: the crown sets transport priorities but must obtain Guild capacity to carry them out.

N-J | Joint authorisation

Power: both Navigation delegates must initial the same order. Neither faction nor the Ascendant can decide alone. If they disagree or miss the deadline, use Close.

Obligation: convoys divide capacity between army and settlements. In round two a funded Convoy gives **Communities +2 and Army +1**. Its Route loss and protection rules still apply.

Resources: Convoy costs 2 Navigators; Repair 2; Close 0. No additional tax or token is required for joint consent.

Settlement meaning: neither institution controls passage alone. Both accept balanced deliveries and the risk of deadlock.

Military articles

CUT INTO THREE | PUBLIC CHARTER OPTIONS

M-I | Imperial command

Power: the Ascendant selects Escort, Requisition or Rest. The Janissariat retains control of its faction commitment.

Obligation: central coordination gives **Army +1** whenever a funded military Escort accompanies a funded Convoy, in addition to all cargo effects. This applies under any Navigation article. Reserve Insurance alone does not earn it.

Resources: Escort costs 2 Force; Requisition 3; Rest 0. Rest gives Army +1 and Communities -1. Insufficient capacity still causes normal failure.

Settlement meaning: the military remains an imperial instrument, with responsibility for coordinated army supply.

M-A | Military autonomy

Power: the Janissariat security delegate selects Escort, Requisition or Rest. The Ascendant cannot countermand that choice.

Obligation: military command must prioritise recovery when resting. **Rest gives Army +2 instead of +1**, and still gives Communities -1. It receives no M-I convoy bonus.

Resources: Escort costs 2 Force; Requisition 3; Rest 0. Only committed Force is available. Autonomy does not supply extra tokens.

Settlement meaning: the Janissariat is an autonomous order responsible for its own readiness; civilian supply is not automatically its first priority.

M-J | Joint authorisation

Power: both Security delegates must initial the same order. If they disagree or miss the deadline, use Rest. The Ascendant has no casting vote.

Obligation: Requisition is forbidden. Civilian cooperation makes **Escort cost 1 Force** instead of 2. Rest remains Army +1 and Communities -1. There is no M-I convoy bonus.

Resources: Escort 1 Force; Rest 0. A Requisition instruction is invalid and defaults to Rest without an unfunded-order penalty.

Settlement meaning: deployments need institutional consent. Local assistance lowers escort costs, in exchange for protection against military requisition.

Imperial orders and interventions

ASCENDANT WORKSHEET | KEEP THE TOKEN ON A LODGED INTERVENTION

Public directives

Use these as working messages. Before the council bell, ensure each legal final order is written and initialled on the relevant council card. A directive cannot override an article that gives someone else authority. A revised directive replaces the earlier one only when entered on that card.

Round	Navigation directive	Security directive
1	_____	_____
2	_____	_____

Ascendant initials: _____ Council card is the final record.

Reserve reference

INSURANCE: triggers only if the final funded Navigation order is Convoy and the final funded Security order is not Escort. Provides protection from the convoy's ordinary Route -1 and from both unescorted-convoy vision hazards. It does not count as a military Escort for the R1 Security bonus, the R1 repaired-route bonus or the M-I bonus.

BRIDGE NAVIGATION / BRIDGE SECURITY: triggers only if the chosen council's legal paid order is short of its cost by **exactly one** committed token. Add that one capacity and run the order. A funded military Escort using Bridge Security counts as an ordinary Escort. No trigger for a zero-cost order, an invalid order, an affordable order or a larger shortfall.

KEEP: do not lodge an intervention. The reserve remains available next round. The reserve is never renewed after use. One intervention cannot fund both councils.

Round one - submit at the faction bell

Vision taken: NAVIGATION / SECURITY
Intervention: KEEP / INSURANCE / BRIDGE NAVIGATION / BRIDGE SECURITY
Ascendant signature: _____
Facilitator: token lodged ____ triggered ____ returned ____

Round two - submit at the faction bell

Vision taken: NAVIGATION / SECURITY
Intervention: KEEP / INSURANCE / BRIDGE NAVIGATION / BRIDGE SECURITY
Ascendant signature: _____
Facilitator: token lodged ____ triggered ____ returned ____

Timing and defaults

The intervention is fixed before either council chooses. Use KEEP if the selection is missing, multiple or late, or the token is already spent. A lodged but untriggered intervention expires at round end; return the token before the next Communion. Unused reserve has no endgame reward.

The state of the empire

PUBLIC BOARD AND CUT-OUT TOKENS

Place this sheet where both councils can see it

Track	0	1	2	3	4
Route			START		
Communities			START		
Army			START		

Use three ordinary counters to mark values, or cross out and rewrite them. Limit each track to 0-4 only after adding all round effects.

Public record	Entry
Current round	1 / 2
Navigation authority	INTERIM / N-G / N-I / N-J
Military authority	INTERIM / M-I / M-A / M-J
Navigator lost?	NO / YES (round-two Guild capacity becomes 2)
Reserve	AVAILABLE / LODGED / SPENT
Round-one final tracks	Route ____ Communities ____ Army ____
Round-two final tracks	Route ____ Communities ____ Army ____

Interim arrangements

Authority: Ascendant chooses both councils' orders. Factions retain their asset commitments. Convoys use the round card's balanced cargo benefits; Escort costs 2; Rest gives Army +1. No Charter-specific bonus applies. These rules return if final ratification fails.

Cut out the six capacity tokens and one Reserve

NAVIGATOR 1	NAVIGATOR 2	NAVIGATOR 3
Guild capacity	Guild capacity	Remove if lost

FORCE 1	FORCE 2	FORCE 3
Janissariat capacity	Janissariat capacity	Janissariat capacity

IMPERIAL RESERVE
ONE USE FOR THE WHOLE GAME

Token handling

Reset capacity each round: 3 Navigators (2 after a loss) and 3 Force. Only committed tokens enter the pools. Spent capacity returns next round; lost capacity does not. Keep the Reserve separate.

NAVIGATION POOL	SECURITY POOL
Committed Navigators: _____	Committed Force: _____
Order cost: _____	Order cost: _____
Reserve bridge used: YES / NO	Reserve bridge used: YES / NO

The Charter of Settlement

CEREMONY SHEET | ONE PACKAGE, THREE SIGNATURES

The provisional arrangements have been tested. Decide what should survive them. You have ten minutes. Choose exactly one article in each category. All six printed options remain available; you may replace the provisional articles.

Select the articles

Navigation - circle ONE:
N-G Guild discretion / N-I Imperial priority / N-J Joint authorisation

Military - circle ONE:
M-I Imperial command / M-A Military autonomy / M-J Joint authorisation

Authorise the settlement

Both members must agree before a faction signs. Your signature approves the entire two-article package, without unwritten conditions. You may withdraw your own approval by crossing out your initials before the deadline. If either article changes, all three parties must sign again in the replacement row. Only the latest complete row for the current package is valid; use the blank space below for further replacement rows if needed.

Approval	Guild: both initials	Janissariat: both initials	Ascendant
First agreement	_____	_____	_____
Replacement	_____	_____	_____

Facilitator: exactly one article per category? ____ All approvals current? ____
At the deadline: **RATIFIED / NOT RATIFIED**

State of the empire at signature

Route: ____ / 4 Communities: ____ / 4 Army: ____ / 4
Navigator lost: YES / NO Reserve used: YES / NO

If ratified

The selected powers and obligations become the final settlement. This does not restore tracks, return a lost navigator or trigger another order. Each faction describes what it secured and what it conceded.

If not ratified

The provisional articles expire. The Ascendant resumes interim policy authority; the Guild and Janissariat retain their assets. The army and settlements remain in their final condition. Negotiations failed to create a durable settlement; this is a playable ending, not a reason to extend the deadline.

Debrief - six minutes

1. Each faction and the Ascendant name one outcome they wanted and whether they achieved it.
2. Did exercising or experiencing provisional authority change which article you wanted?
3. Which decision at another table mattered most to you?
4. Did foresight create useful choices? Did both faction members contribute?
5. Record one change for the next test. Do not try to redesign everything at once.